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Virginia House of Delegates Floor Session, Regular Session, Monday, March 9, 2026

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[00:11:37] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Sergeant-at-Arms. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:11:54] The memos will rise and be led in prayer by Dr. J. Michael Sage, Pastor, Freedom Tabernacle Church, Atkins. We remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Henry. Thank you. Let us bow for prayer.

[00:12:13] Heavenly Father, overshadow our military and their families, especially those serving in harm's way. And I am humbly honored to once again stand in this oldest legislative body in our nation, having first met 407 years ago.

[00:12:33] Amazing. In the church there at Jamestown. Preacher Richard Buck offered the very first invocation, beseeching you to guide and sanctify all of our proceedings. for prayer is a necessary start to business.

[00:12:50] And now, as our record shows, we Virginians believe our affairs do little prosper where your service is neglected. May we hear again with clarity the sacred creed. Do unto others as you would have them do unto you.

[00:13:11] Be patient with our divisions, O God, for your warning remains. A house divided cannot stand. So as we rigorously debate, help us to respectfully seek common, solid ground whereupon each citizen may firmly stand together as Virginians.

[00:13:34] I request your wisdom to rest upon each delegate and staff member. Bless their families and the whole round of their lives. Now, they've worked hard this session on the business of our commonwealth, and may their labor afford the highest good to each citizen.

[00:13:51] You see the contents and intents of each heart, O Lord, so please help us to seek pure hearts over partisan hearts, always placing the people above a party. Lord God Almighty, in keeping with our historic heritage, in the name of the author and finisher of my faith, my wonderful Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ, I ask your continuing best blessings upon our home, Virginia, from the bay to the gap, and all points in between.

[00:14:29] Amen. Amen.

[00:14:31] The members will ask for the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:15:20] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, quorums present. Assuming to House Rule 3, I have examined and approved the journal of the House of Delegates for Friday, March 6th, 2026. Motions and resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:15:39] Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? Yes, sir, Mr. Speaker, a number of, beginning communication from the Senate. The Senate has rejected, excuse me, the Senate has receded, the Senate has receded from its amendments to the following legislation, House Bill 19. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring.

[00:15:55] That's just information, okay, that's great. And Ms. Speaker, continuing on communication, another communication from the Senate. They have insisted on amendments and requested committees of conference on the following legislation. House Bill 75, 110, 318, 319, 505, 667, 836, 1385, 1441, 1524, as well as House Bill 1525.

[00:16:21] The delegate from Alexander, Delga Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House accede to the request of the Senate for committees of conference on the previously reported legislation. Detective Alexander, Detective Heron moves that the House accede to the Senate's request for committees of conference and, of course, with the previously announced legislation from the clerk. All those in favor, say aye.

[00:16:37] All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, another communication from the Senate. They have rejected the House amendments to the following legislation. Senate Bills 137, 142, 158, 351, 352, 364, 382, 496, 643, 777, 783, and Senate Bill 812.

[00:17:00] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House insist on its amendments and request committees a conference on the previously reported legislation. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the House insists on its amendments and request committees of conference on the previous announced legislation. As many in favor, the motion will say aye.

[00:17:17] Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, points on behalf of the House, a number of conferees as we approach the deadline for Thursday to get all bills have to be in conference by

Thursday to the procedure resolution. For House Bill 77, the Speaker points on behalf of the House, conferees, Delegates Kriesick, Glass, and Cornett.

[00:17:38] House Bill 77, Delegates Kresick, Glass, and Cornett. On House Bill 84, the Speaker appoints Delegates Lawfer, Sullivan, and Webber. House Bill 84, Delegates Lawfer, Sullivan, and Webber. For House Bill 476, Speaker appoints on behalf of the House Delegates Watts, Willett, and Walker.

[00:17:56] HB 476, Delegates Watts, Willett, and Walker. House Bill 625, Speaker appoints Delegates Henson, Ward, and McLaughlin. HB 625, Delegates Henson, Ward, and McLaughlin, and finally, for Senate Bill 140, the Speaker appoints Delegates Sullivan, Pope Adams, and Wright. Senate Bill 140, Delegates Sullivan, Pope Adams, and Wright, and the companion legislation is House Bill 325. All of the committee, conference committee appointments are on your member page as well. Finally, I simply would remind the body that all commending memorial, joint commending and memorial resolutions

[00:18:34] are due today by 5:00 to the front desk. Today's the last day for committee action on legislation. By way of just a simple reminder, as we go on this last week, all requests for drafts, redrafts, and corrections for single house commending memorial resolutions to legislative services by 5:00 tomorrow. And then all single house commending single house ones have to be to the front desk here on Thursday by 5:00. Mr. Speaker, that's all the announcements I have at this time.

[00:19:00] DELEGATE CORNETT: Delegate from Grayson. DELEGATE CORNETT: Thank you, Mr. Speaker, Ross for an introduction. Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the house, today our invocation was given by Pastor Mike Sage. If he would stand up in the back, please. Pastor Sage serves as the pastor of Freedom Tabernacle Baptist Church in Atkins, Virginia. He began his ministry at a young age as an evangelist in 1975 and just a few years later helped establish Freedom Tabernacle in 1978. Since then, he has faithfully served as the church's pastor and director of Freedom Tabernacle Ministries. For decades, that ministry has worked

[00:19:38] to share the gospel through Southwest Virginia with a simple mission to save lives, to see lives changed, souls saved through knowing Christ. Alongside that work, the church is deeply involved in serving the community, from children's ministries that invest in the next generation to outreach like Hadassah Home, a faith-based shelter that provides safe housing and support for women and children in crosses.

[00:20:03] Through Pastor Sage's leadership, that work has touched many families across our region and the Commonwealth. So I'd ask my colleagues in the house, give him a warm house welcome. Welcome to the Capitol, Dr. Sage.

[00:20:25] Thank you for that history lesson and prayer. The delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today, I rise to recognize a pillar of faith and service in the 65th District, Union Bell Baptist Church, and I would ask that they would please stand.

[00:20:45] Visiting with us today are two ministries for Union Bell Baptist Church, the youth ministry and the Silver Eagles ministry. For generations, Union Bell has been more than just a place of worship. It has been a sanctuary for the weary, a pantry for the hungry, and a beacon of hope for our community. Their commitment to the spiritual and social fabric of our commonwealth remains unwavering.

[00:21:05] Mr. Speaker, it's also my distinct honor to share with you that just last month, the Union Bell Baptist Church family gathered to celebrate a monumental milestone, the 24th pastoral anniversary of our pastor. For nearly a quarter of a century, our pastor has modeled the very definition of servant leadership.

[00:21:24] Through seasons of challenge and seasons of triumph, they have provided a steady hand and a compassionate heart, not only to their congregation, but to the entire community. To lead the flock for 24 years is a testament to endurance, character, and a profound love for one's neighbor. I ask it to be the privilege of the body to give this Union Bell Baptist Church A warm house welcome and joining me in celebrating 103 years of ministry and 24 years in pastoral ministry.

[00:21:50] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett.

[00:22:06] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Arise with a motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that we take up H.R. 210, buy for the day, take H.R. 210, buy for the day, and ask that it be re-docketed for Thursday on page 41 of the calendar, without objection. Without objection, House Resolution 210 is...

[00:22:32] By until March 12th. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Martinado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker and members of the House, today joining us in the gallery is the Disability Caucus of the Virginia Young Democrats, and I ask them to rise.

[00:22:53] The Disability Caucus works to promote disability rights, raise awareness, and empower the voices of Virginians with disabilities across the Commonwealth, helping ensure that our policies create greater equity, access, and opportunity for all. I'm especially grateful for their partnership in advancing HB 671, which passed this House and the Senate, as we work together to prohibit disability-based discrimination in jury service and ensuring individuals can request an exemption if their disability prevents them from serving.

[00:23:24] Their advocacy reflects an ongoing commitment to accessibility, fairness, and full civic participation. Mr. Speaker, I ask the members of this body to join me in giving a warm House welcome to Virginia Young Democrats Disability Caucus today. Thank you. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:23:49] Delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Scott. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that we take up out of order House Joint Resolution, or House HJ 210 on page 37 of today's calendar. Delegate, truck report resolution.

[00:24:07] Ms. Speaker, House Joint Resolution 210, commending Alexander Huey. Delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Scott. Mr. Speaker, I move the resolution, I move the adoption of the resolution, and I request to speak to the motion. Doug has the floor. Mr. Speaker, it's an honor to welcome the Honorable Ambassador Alexander Yui, his family, and members of the staff, if they would please rise.

[00:24:29] They are here today in this historic chamber in Virginia, the birthplace of American democracy. This year marks the 250th anniversary of our nation's Declaration of Independence, a milestone that reminds us of the enduring power of self-government, limited government, and the principles that define us.

[00:24:49] At the same time, our friends in Taiwan are celebrating 30 years since their first direct presidential election in 1996. These milestones, though different, highlight the shared commitment to

Democratic-Republican governance that unites us.

[00:25:05] Taiwan has built a strong, vibrant democracy from challenging beginnings, much like our own path our nation has traveled. Both systems rest on the same core foundations of free and fair elections, the rule of law, separation of powers, and the protection of individual rights.

[00:25:23] In Taiwan, as here in Virginia and across the United States, democracy is strengthened by active citizens who are dedicated to freedom. These shared values form the basis for our strong relationship. It is my pleasure to introduce the Honorable Ambassador Alexander Yui, representative of the Taipei Economic and Cultural Representative Office in the United States, Taiwan's representative to our country.

[00:25:48] Ambassador Yui brings extensive diplomatic experience and has played a key role in strengthening U.S. and Taiwan ties. Mr. Speaker, I renew my motion that H.J. 210 be agreed to. And after passing the resolution, I ask the members of the House of Delegates in extending a warm Virginia welcome to the Ambassador, his family, and his staff.

[00:26:09] The delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Scott, moves at the House of House Joint Resolution 210 committing Alexander Yui. All those in favor shall say aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations, sir. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew.

[00:26:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today I'm honored to recognize a few bright young students joining us today from Providence Elementary School in Virginia Beach. And if they're here, can they please rise? Today they're here to see firsthand how we craft the laws that shape their community in our Commonwealth, especially rewarding to welcome them as our nation prepares to mark the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence, It's a moment that connects the lessons they're learning in history at school to the world work we're doing here in this chamber.

[00:27:08] Ms. Speaker, members of the House, please join me in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Adele from Chesterfield, Delegate Maida.

[00:27:27] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise today for the purpose of a motion and a resolution. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move to take up HJR 198 out of order, which can be found on page 36, and I'd like to speak to that resolution.

[00:27:46] Clerk will report a resolution. House Dorn Resolution 198, commending Brad Hughes. The delegate from Chesterfield. Delegate May. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move this resolution for a man whose life is a powerful testament to bravery, integrity, and unwavering perseverance.

[00:28:04] Special Deputy Brad Hughes, who is in the gallery. I ask that he raise his hand to be noticed. On March 17, 2014, Deputy Hughes, an officer with the Powhatan Sheriff's Office, answered the call to serve, just as he always had.

[00:28:25] While on scene of a dangerous accident, he focused not on himself, but on the lives he could save. While assisting victims of a horrific crash, Deputy Hughes was struck by a distracted driver and suffered life-altering injuries that ultimately led to the loss of both of his legs.

[00:28:49] Many would understand, Mr. Speaker, if such a tragedy ended a career of service. But for Deputy Hughes, it marked the beginning of a new mission. Rather than retreat, he moved forward,

committing himself to raising awareness about the dangers of distracted driving so that no other family would endure similar pain and heartache.

[00:29:16] As a member of the Powhatan County Sheriff's Office, he has shared his story with more than 40,000 students and community members, urging them to make responsible choices when behind the wheel. Through his resilience, Mr. Speaker, he has turned pain into purpose and adversity into action.

[00:29:42] Deputy Hughes exemplifies the very highest ideals of public service. His dedication reminds us that real leadership begins with character and that the greatest impact often comes from those who serve quietly, faithfully and with purpose.

[00:30:04] It is my distinct honor and privilege to recognize and introduce a true leader, a role model in our community, and an inspiration to all who believe in the power of service. I move the adoption of the resolution and ask that the House please join me in honoring Deputy Brad Hughes with a warm House welcome.

[00:30:30] The delegate from Chesterfield, the delegate from Chesterfield. The delegate from the House will come to order. One second. I hate when y'all do that. The delegate from Chesterfield moves the adoption of House Joint Resolution 198.

[00:30:49] Commending Brad Hughes. All those in favor of the motion will say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations and thank you. Thank you. Now you may serve.

[00:31:11] It always confuses everybody. Thank you, sir. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor.

[00:31:27] Thank you. Mr. Speaker, in the gallery today, we have students from Jobs for Virginia Graduates. I ask that they please rise. Jobs for Virginia Graduates is a nonprofit that propels underserved students towards graduation and college or career opportunities. Since 1998, they have helped tens of thousands of students graduate and achieve long-term success.

[00:31:48] If you head to their website, you'll see some impressive statistics about their participants, including a graduation rate that's 8% higher than the average, 89% who achieve full-time employment, and 95% who pursue further education after graduation. They are present in 62 schools and across 43 school divisions in Virginia and continue to grow their service.

[00:32:09] And with that, I request that the members join me in extending them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Fagans.

[00:32:26] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, in the back of the chamber is the Miles Agency, and I ask that they please rise. The Miles Agency has guided outreach, communications, transportation, resilience, and public health and public works initiatives across the Commonwealth.

[00:32:44] Additionally, we just passed House Resolution 168 that honors Delcino Miles, who serves as the Miles Agency CEO for her service as the first black chair of the Hampton Roads Chamber of Commerce Regional Board. She was also recently recognized as the 73rd first citizen of Virginia Beach.

[00:33:01] Additionally, Delcino has worked hard for years to make change in the 757 and beyond in a bipartisan and extremely successful way. Members, I ask that you please join me in giving the Miles Agency and Delcino a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:33:27] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Just going down the best row. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. I move that H.R. 224 on page 31 of the calendar be passed by until Wednesday, March 11th.

[00:33:45] Without objection, House Resolution 231 is by until March 11th. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of a motion.

[00:34:01] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House take up out of order, House Resolution 320. On what page? Mr. Speaker, it's not on the calendar yet. clerk will report a resolution house resolution 320 commending claude w harrison delegate from fairfax delegation thank you mr speaker i would move adoption of the resolution and if i could please speak to that motion the delegate has the floor thank you mr speaker we have in the gallery with us today mr claude harrison or as i knew him clerk claude and if i could ask him to please stand mr speaker this one's personal for me because clerk claude um served this body in the

[00:34:39] House Committee operations for more than a decade, and for several of those years, he was the clerk of CC&T. I got to know Clerk Claude well during our early Friday morning subcommittee meetings, and I can tell you there are very few people who have brought more warmth, professionalism, and heart to their work in this building. Claude is a true Virginian. He grew up in Emporia, graduated from the University of Virginia, and became a registered architect practicing in Richmond and elsewhere in the Commonwealth. He built a distinguished career in facilities management at United Virginia Bank, Central Fidelity Bank, where he served as vice president, at Wachovia as the Virginia real estate manager, and later joining the law firm Williams Mullen as its first ever director of facilities.

[00:35:20] Claude retired from his career in 2011, before he started with us in the House in 2012, and Claude and his dear wife, Sue, had always talked about coming to work together at the General Assembly in their retirement, and heartbreakingly, she passed away before they could see through their post-retirement plans together, and in spite of that, he decided to keep with the plan and begin his work with us on the House Clerk team in 2012. Claude served as a clerk for the Transportation Committee, and then as a room clerk, and ultimately as the clerk of CC&T. He earned the trust and respect of every committee chair he worked with, and if you ask anyone apparently on the House Committee Operations team, they will tell you that Claude also served

[00:35:57] as the unofficial social director of their team, often bringing folks together, and I even had the opportunity to once crash one of their parties. It was at the Jefferson, which should tell you, Mr. Speaker, that Claude also has impeccable taste. And if you ask him, Mr. Speaker, Claude might tell you, and he told this to my staff personally, that the reason he finally retired from the House was because I kept making him show up in the wee morning hours of Friday. And so, Clerk Claude, I apologize for making you wake up so early on Fridays, but only a little bit because I still have to be here on Fridays at 7 a.m. The now Secretary of the Commonwealth and formerly

[00:36:33] the formidable chair of CC&T, Candy King, also asked me to convey the following words about her time working with Claude. She said, Claude was a dutiful clerk who kept me in line. I thank him for his service and wish him the best. Mr. Speaker, Claude threatened me with retirement on a number of occasions over the four sessions we worked together, and each time I asked him not to leave us. In 2024, after we flipped the majority in the house, Claude confessed he had yet again considered leaving, but that he wanted to stay one more year to help the new majority find our footing. And true to his word, when he

retired after the 2025 session, he said to me he felt like he could finally retire because he was confident we would be fine without him. In

[00:37:11] retirement, Claude has kept busy. He is a proud father of two grown children and grandfather to a granddaughter. He is an avid gardener, a lover of travel, and he has turned his passion for antiquing into a side hustle. And next Monday, or next month, Claude will celebrate his 80th birthday. Mr. Speaker, Clerk Claude gave the Spotty years of dedicated service, and before that, He gave decades of his profession to the Commonwealth.

[00:37:33] It's my honor to recognize him today, to thank him for his service on behalf of all of us for everything he has done. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Fairfax. I got it now. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin, moves that the House adopt House Resolution No. 320, commending Claude W. Harrison.

[00:37:50] All those in favor of the motion shall say aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations, sir. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson.

[00:38:11] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House take up out of order House Resolution 195 on page 40 of today's calendar. Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution 195, commending the First Baptist Church of Williamsburg.

[00:38:36] Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the resolution and request to speak to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members from Williamsburg Historic First Baptist Church have joined us in the gallery today, and I ask that they please rise for recognition. Mr. Speaker, this year, First Baptist Church in Williamsburg celebrates its 250th anniversary.

[00:38:58] As one of the oldest African-American congregants in our nation, their roots run deep in our community and date back to the founding of our nation. The church was formed in 1776 when a group of free and enslaved black people began bravely and secretly meeting for worship.

[00:39:16] Throughout the years, the church has physically relocated several times in our community with its first home in James City County to its present location in the city of Williamsburg. First Baptist Church has remained a consistent beacon of hope and refuge for those living in Williamsburg. They have faithfully answered God's call to welcome and love all who enter their front doors and over the years and have been a steady presence in my community for the past two and a half centuries.

[00:39:42] I will say, anyone familiar with First Baptist Church, you know of the 1886 Freedom Bell that resides in the front of the building. I've had the privilege of ringing said bell, along with amazing people such as President Barack Obama, Dionne Warwick, Jesse Jackson, and the descendants of Thomas Jefferson and Sally Hemings. Led by many faithful pastors who have guided the congregation through various trials in our nation's history, their steadfast commitment to sharing the good news has never wavered.

[00:40:13] Mr. Speaker, I'd like to thank First Baptist Church for their work and their ministry and wish them continued success in their next 250 years. And after we adopt the resolution, I ask my fellow members to give them a warm House welcome.

[00:40:28] The delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson, moves that the House adopt House Resolution 195, convening the First Baptist Church of Williamsburg. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations.

[00:40:55] Delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I request that Senate Bill 47 on page 2 be moved to the regular calendar and taken by for the day.

[00:41:13] Without objection. We would do it, but that's okay. We got it. Without objection. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McPike. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion and a purpose of an introduction. Doug has the floor.

[00:41:29] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House take up out of order, House Joint Resolution 197 on page 36 of today's calendar. Clerk with Port of Resolution. House Joint Resolution 197. The House Joint Redout 97 commending Port City Brewing Company. Delegate from Orleans, Delegate Mike Pike.

[00:41:46] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the resolution. I request to speak to the motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 197 commends Port City Brewing Company of Alexandria for reaching a milestone. Fifteen years in operation brewing the best beer in America in the best city in America.

[00:42:03] Bill Butcher, who owns Port City with his wife Karen, is with us in the gallery today on behalf of their entire team. I would like to ask him to stand. Mr. Speaker, Port City is a beloved local institution in Alexandria that is brought renowned to our Commonwealth and my district. Their beers have repeatedly been honored with awards at national and international brewers competitions.

[00:42:23] Port City is the most awarded brewery at the Virginia Craft Beer Cup with 33 medals. But more than that, Mr. Speaker, Port City is a symbol of how resilient and deeply interconnected Virginia's economy is. All of the wheat used to make many of Port City's beers, including its multi-award-winning Optimal Wit, is grown in Northumberland County at Bay's Best Feed in Heathville, Virginia.

[00:42:45] Over the past 15 years, Port City has grown its operations and sustained itself through economic upturns and downturns, a derecho that they eventually named a beer after, and even a global pandemic, all the while also supporting the farmers that grow that wheat. Port City's success in Alexandria has fostered success for its partner, Farms, an example we should all remember.

[00:43:06] Port City's story reminds us that we should never pit one region of Virginia against another. We are all one commonwealth, rising or falling together. Operating and growing a business is hard, particularly in a competitive industry like brewing. The butchers in Port City haven't just grown a business, they have grown Virginia's economy.

[00:43:23] And with that, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption resolution and ask the members join me in giving Bill and Port City Brewing a warm house welcome. the delegate from after the vote please the delegate from arlington delegate mike pike moves at the house adopt house joint resolution 197 you're not from alexandria mr speaker the dog from alexandria delegate mike pike moves at the house adopt house joint resolution 197 committee port city brewing company all those in favor will say aye all those opposed no the

[00:43:56] motion is agreed to congratulations delegate the delegate from hampton delegate ward thank you mr Mr. Speaker, Mr. Speaker, I rise for an announcement.

[00:44:13] The Junker has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today is a great day in the Commonwealth. Today, we will reactivate a caucus that has been dormant for many years. The caucus could be called the majority caucus because it's so large. It's comprised of Democrats and Republicans, men, women, rural and urban with everything in between.

[00:44:34] We are united, Mr. Speaker. We are strong. We are bold. We are the unbirthdayed. We are the majority of those serving in this chamber, yet we have never received a standing ovation on this house floor when it's our birthday. No one will throw us a birthday party for us.

[00:44:53] No one will slip little gift cards in our hands saying, go buy something nice for yourself, it's your birthday. Nobody takes us out for dinner or drinks and say, it's your birthday. No, Mrs. Speaker, we are the ones whose birthdays fall either before or after session our birthdays are overlooked because we are unbirthdayed but no longer mr speaker the other day delegate martinez came to me with a sad look in his eyes and he said what about us our birthdays

[00:45:32] are always overlooked so on that day mr speaker i named him the chair of the unbirthdayed caucus and many of you, we have so many members and many of you don't have to worry about anything because you're probably a member of that caucus anyway. You may not know because we have no meetings. We have no agenda. The only thing we do, Mr. Speaker, is we just clap our hands when everyone else is celebrating their birthday. But I just want to let you know, we're not mad.

[00:46:10] We're not jealous because we have planned our own unbirthday caucus today in the members lounge. Everyone is invited. You'll get an unbirthday cupcake. And Delegate McQueen wants you to know that she has also added a lot of other desserts.

[00:46:29] Everybody in this chamber, a lot of you have added desserts. You didn't know that you were adding it to the unbirthday caucus, but we're going to claim them too. But we're hoping that you will go back, and we should have a giant unbirthdate card also back there for you to sign the unbirthdate card.

[00:46:49] And, Mr. Speaker, I just ask your indulgence for just one moment, one little thing. I ask, if it's not too much, if you would allow us to give a warm wish to all the unbirthdate members so we can wish them a very happy, it's not your birthday.

[00:47:08] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from here, right? Go, Delegate McQuinn.

[00:47:27] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. And I'm glad you called my name. Mr. Speaker, I would like for you to know, and the members of this GA of the House, that there was a dessert party that was planned, Mr. Speaker.

[00:47:44] And only today did I realize that the unbirthday caucus hijacked the dessert day. So I want to get that straight when someone said, we brought a little dessert. We have been planning desserts for a while, Mr. Speaker, as we have done every year and until the unbirthday caucus of two hijacked, of two, what, of two hijacked the dessert party today.

[00:48:16] But anyway, plenty of desserts are out there and a lot of unbirthday cupcakes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Herico, Delegate Willett.

[00:48:33] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It's not my birthday, but I do. I do rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that we take H.R. 235, found on page 43, to be passed by until Wednesday, March 11th.

[00:48:52] Without objection, H.R. 235, found on page 43, is by until March 11th. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for two motions. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 261, on page 16 of the calendar, be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations.

[00:49:09] Senate Bill 261 on page 16, re-referred to appropriations. Delegate from Fairfax moves that Senate Bill 216, found on page 16, be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations.

[00:49:26] All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. SB 261 is re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations. Your second motion. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 84 on page 81 of the calendar be re-referred to the Committee on Transportation. Senate Bill 84 on page 81 be re-referred to the Committee on Transportation.

[00:49:43] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, moves that Senate Bill 84 found on page 81 be re-referred to the Committee on Transportation. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is re-referred to the Committee on Transportation.

[00:50:04] The Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Doherty. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of two motions. The Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, first, I request that House Resolution 273 on page 32 of the calendar be moved to this Wednesday, March 11th.

[00:50:20] Without objection, House Resolution 273 found on page 32 is by until March 11th. Your second motion. Yes, Mr. Speaker. I also request that House Resolution 206 on page 41 of the calendar be moved to this Thursday, March 12th.

[00:50:38] Without objection, House Resolution 206 found on page 41 is by until March 12th. Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, and I want to thank you for giving me leave to do this very special presentation this morning.

[00:50:57] Mr. Speaker, joining us in the back of the chamber this morning is an extraordinary educator and leader who has dedicated more than four decades to serving the students and families of Fredericksburg. Dr. Marceline Marcy Catlett is joining us, and I would ask that also her family and friends in the gallery, along with the Fredericksburg School Board, please rise as well.

[00:51:18] Dr. Catlett began her journey in Fredericksburg City Public Schools as a student, graduating in 1977, and returned just a few years later to begin her career as a 6th grade teacher at Walker Grant Middle School. Through years of dedication, leadership, and unwavering commitment to student success, she rose to the ranks of the school division and now serves as a superintendent of Fredericksburg City Public Schools.

[00:51:40] Under her leadership, the division has strengthened academic opportunities, expanded career and technical education and deepen engagement with families and the community. This year, her work was recognized statewide when she was named the 2026 Region 3 Superintendent of the Year by the Virginia Association of School Superintendents. She is joined today by members of her family, the Fredericksburg City School Board, and we are here to celebrate this achievement. I would hope it would be the privilege of the body to give Dr. Catlett and the Fredericksburg City School Board

[00:52:11] a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McPike. Still from Alexandria, Mr. Speaker. Oh, I'm sorry. The Delegate from Alexandria,

Delegate McPike. I appreciate that, Mr. Speaker. And to be fair, Arlington is my favorite suburb of the city of Alexandria. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a purpose of a motion and

[00:52:47] an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House take up out of order, House Joint Resolution 196 on page 36 of today's calendar. Kirk will report a resolution. House Joint Resolution 196, commending the staff of Theogony. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate McPike.

[00:53:05] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the resolution and I request to speak to the motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 196 is a resolution that commends some of the best journalists in all of Virginia, the student journalists at Alexandria City High School's Theogony newspaper. Byron Labresco, one of the student staffers of Theogony, is with us today in the gallery alongside his grandmother and mother, an audacity stand.

[00:53:27] He is. As someone who's run for office in Alexandria three times in the last five years, I've seen firsthand how skilled and insightful these young reporters are when it comes to covering local news. Further, as a former high school journalist myself, I have been deeply impressed by their dedication to the First Amendment.

[00:53:43] When new policies were proposed that would have undercut the First Amendment rights of student journalists at ACHS, the staffers of Theogony didn't just accept the changes or complain about them, they drafted their own alternative policy and rallied the public to their side. Their courageous stand not only earned them the respect of their fellow students and Alexandrians, they have also received the Courage in Student Journalism Award from the Student Press Law Center and the National Scholastic Press Association, and will soon receive the Joseph W. Showquist Freedom of the Press Award at the Southern Interscholastic Press Association convention. Mr. Speaker, at a time when it is easy to become jaded or cynical about the state of journalism in our country, the students of Alexandria City High School give us reasons to

[00:54:23] be hopeful for the future. For that reason, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption resolution, and after the adoption resolution, Mr. Speaker, members, I ask that the members join me in giving Byron and Theogony a warm house welcome. The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate McPipe, moves that the House adopt House Joint Resolution 196, committing the staff of theogony. As many favor the motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations, young man.

[00:55:03] Clerk will announce the next order of business. Oh, pursuant to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business on a granted leave from today's session. Delegates Henson and Hope. Clerk will announce the next order of business. Second portion of the morning hour is reserved for the announcement. Member requests for legislation to be moved from uncontested to regular.

[00:55:23] There is one, page two, the first category of today's calendar, Senate Bill's third uncontested, Senator Craig's SB 47, is out of the block and over to the regular calendar. Chuck, we'll announce the next auto bill. Third portion of the morning, our reserve for member requests for legislation to go by for today, and if such, the subsequent motion by the Majority Leader, there are nine.

[00:55:43] That same bill just a moment ago in Senate Bill's third reading, Uncontested, page 2, Senator Craig's SB 47 is by for the day as well, at the request of Delegate Wyatt. On page 8, in that same category, Senator Sturdivant's SB 568 is by for the day at the request of Delegate Tram.

[00:56:07] New category, Senate Bill's third reading regular, page 12, Senator Pekarski's SB 108, by for the day. Same category, page 15, Senator Jones's SB 220 is by for the day.

[00:56:23] Same category down on page 20, Senator Rouse's SB 518, as well as that same page, Senator Obenshain's SB 536, those are by for the day. And on page, let's see, on the category of House bills with Senate amendments, Page 23, Delegate Hope's, HB 481, all of those are at the request of Delegate Tran.

[00:56:52] Over in the category of Memorial Resolutions, Senator Stewart's, SJ 149 on page 26 is by for the day at the request of Delegate Wyatt. And then on the same category, but moving forward to page 28, Delegate Carr's, HJ 231, by for the day at the request of Delegate Tran.

[00:57:12] That is... all of the announcements that I'm aware of, sir. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, we had one bill to that, Senate Bill 20 on page 12 of the calendar. Page 12, Senate Bill 20, bye for the day.

[00:57:34] Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation, as announced by the clerk, go bye for the day. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation, as announced by the clerk, go bye for the day. If you submit in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will announce the next order.

[00:57:50] And the fourth and final portion of the morning, I reserve for member requests for points of personal privilege. Kindly use your request to speak button to get into the queue for the benefit of the speaker. Doug from Prince William, Doug at Guzman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:58:06] I would like to recognize Supreme Court Justice Sonia Sotomayor during Women's History Month and highlight her powerful story. Sonia Sotomayor's journey from a public housing project to Princeton and Yellow, and later to the highest court in the country, speaks to the power of determination and the importance of representation.

[00:58:31] During her time at Princeton, she often felt the weight of being one of the few students of color. However, instead of letting the feelings of alienation hold her back, she became co-chair of the Puerto Rican student group, Acción Puerto Riqueña, advocating for more diversity on campus and pushing for more inclusive academic programs.

[00:58:54] In 2009, her career reached a historic milestone when President Barack Obama nominated her to the United States Supreme Court. Her confirmation made history as the first Latina to serve on the court, an achievement that resonated deeply with Hispanic and Latino communities across our country.

[00:59:16] As a proud Latina immigrant myself, Mr. Speaker, Justice Sotomayor's story has always meant something deeply personal to me. For so many of us who came to this country seeking opportunities, her life reminds us that our stories belong in every space where decisions are made, whether in our courts, our legislatures, or our communities.

[00:59:40] Justice Sotomayor is often called the people's justice because she brings empathy, humanity, and lived experience to the law. Through her work, she has reminded us that justice must serve everyone, especially those whose voices have too often gone unheard.

[01:00:00] During Women's History Month, we celebrate women who have broken barriers and expanded what is possible for the generations that follow. Justice Sonia Sotomayor has done exactly that. And

because of leaders like her, so many young girls, especially Latina girls, can look at the highest court in the land and see a reflection of their own potential.

[01:00:26] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Farquhar County, Delegate Weber. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege.

[01:00:50] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise today with a concern that I believe many Virginians feel but struggle to articulate. The political volatility we are witnessing did not appear overnight.

[01:01:10] It is a monster that has long lurked beneath the surface, growing slowly as wounds were left untended, grievances allowed to fester. When people begin to feel their voices no longer matter, anger builds. And anger, when left unchecked, erupts.

[01:01:32] Rage narrows our vision. It constricts our perspective. It blinds us to the fullness of the truth. And when our vision narrows, we forget there is always another side.

[01:01:49] Blaise Pascal warned that when truth is obscured and falsehoods are firmly established, only those who sincerely love the truth will recognize it. Our danger today is not disagreement. Disagreement is natural in a republic. It is healthy. It is necessary. Our danger is attachment. Attachment to faction, attachment to narrative, attachment to

[01:02:25] power. When attachment hardens, persuasion gives way to hostility. Mr. Speaker, I believe that that That is at the heart of the matter before this body when we discuss gerrymandering and so many of the structural issues that shape our politics.

[01:02:44] When districts are engineered to eliminate competition, persuasion becomes unnecessary. And when persuasion becomes unnecessary, extremism becomes profitable. Our founders understood that danger.

[01:03:01] That is why the seal of the commonwealth has two sides. On the obverse, virtuous stands victorious over tyranny beneath the word "Six Semper Tyrannis." It is a declaration of courage and resistance, but there is also a reverse.

[01:03:22] On that reverse, Libertas and Eternatus turn towards Ceres, the goddess of agriculture, symbolizing abundance, continuity, and sustenance. Above it rests a single word, preservando, by preserving.

[01:03:42] The message is profound. Liberty must be defended, but it must also be sustained. It is a reminder that liberty without order collapses, that revolution without perseverance decays, and that freedom without prosperity becomes fragile. James Madison warned us about factions, about the danger that passion, unchecked by accountability, would sacrifice the public good.

[01:04:11] Extreme gerrymandering insulates power from accountability. It rewards purity over persuasion. And power does not wait to become permanent before it corrupts. It only requires insulation. When districts are drawn to guarantee outcomes, compromise is punished. Extremes are rewarded, And disagreement hardens into moral warfare.

[01:04:39] We see it in our national discourse. We see it in immigration debates where fear replaces facts on one side and denial replaces responsibility on the other. There are those who lump all immigrants together to stoke fear. There are those who refuse to acknowledge that serious crimes must be addressed.

[01:05:00] The truth lies in neither extreme. The truth lies in accountability and opportunity. Removing those who commit heinous crimes while protecting those who follow the law and seek to contribute. That is why many of us supported HB 1262, ensuring immigrant communities are protected from predatory service providers while upholding the rule of law.

[01:05:31] That is preservation. If we continue down a path where political structures eliminate competition and reward partisan orthodoxy, we will no longer debate policy. We will police purity. And purity politics always ends the same way.

[01:05:50] with division hardened into hatred. Hatred does not allow you to see the other side. Mr. Speaker, Virginia's history is as beautiful as it is flawed. It is strong as it is fragile.

[01:06:07] The seal reminds us that the Commonwealth was not founded merely to spark revolution, but to sustain self-government across generations. Let us not feed the monster. Let us widen our vision. Let us restore persuasion. Let us choose preservation over provocation. That, Mr. Speaker, is what it means to preserve.

[01:06:33] Thank you.

[01:06:42] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I request that we move back to the first morning hour for the purpose of a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we re-referred Senate Bill 84 on page 81 of the calendar of the Committee on Transportation, I move that we reconsider that vote.

[01:07:04] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, having voted on the prevailing side by which we re-referred SB 84 to the Committee on Transportation, Moves that we reconsider that vote. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to.

[01:07:20] That's SB 84, found on page 81. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. That stays on second read, Mr. Speaker. You have to make a motion now, right? Just bring it back. It'll be on the calendar. Okay, on second read. Okay. Call the calendar.

[01:07:36] Calendar for today, Monday, March 9th, for the Virginia House of Delegates. Some 46 bills and 200-ish resolutions to be dispensed with. First category, Senate Bill's on third reading uncontested calendar, page 2, Senate Bill 47, is by for the day.

[01:07:56] Therefore, the first bill in today's category is top of page 3, Senate Bill 55, which is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to sex offenses prohibiting proximity to children, state parks penalty.

[01:08:12] Legislation originally reported by the Committee for Courts of Justice and subsequently by the Committee on Appropriation. That is from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 55 prohibits proximity to children in state parks if that is the only intent of going next to the facility.

[01:08:28] I hope that it will be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 91, which is a legislature that seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to public institutions of higher education. Old Dominion University, Eastern Virginia Health Sciences Center, renamed as Virginia Health Sciences.

[01:08:45] Legislation Report Committee on Education. The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 91 simply renames Eastern Virginia Health Sciences Center at ODU as

the Virginia Health Sciences at ODU.

[01:09:01] I hope it would be a pleasure to the body to pass the bill. Over on page four, we come to Senate Bill 105, which seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to science, technology, engineering, mathematics, and computing, STEM plus C. competition team grant program eligibility for grants legislation reporting committee on education with amendment nature substitute Doug from Roanoke City Delegate Russell Mr.

[01:09:24] Speaker move the committee substitute shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye aye all those opposed no the committee substitute is agreed to Doug from Roanoke City Delegate Russell thank you Mr. Speaker this simply refines the eligibility around some stem c competition grant program eligibility hope you pleasure body pass the bill next up in the uncontested third reading blocks on bill 171 which seeks to amend and reenact Four or three sections of the Code of Virginia related to discharge plans for minors admitted to inpatient treatment.

[01:09:50] Copies provided to public elementary and secondary schools. Notification to parents. Health records. Privacy exemption. This legislation for the Committee on Education, again, with Amendment Nature Substitute. Delegate for Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Mr. Speaker, move the committee substitutes. Shall the committee substitutes be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:10:05] The committee substitutes agree to the Delegate for Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 171 discusses how discharge plans are then transmitted from a health facility to a school. I hope you pleasure the body to pass the bill. Overall, on page 5, we come to Senate Bill 326, which seeks to amend and reenact the Texas Code of Virginia, related to the Virginia Public Procurement Act, Cooperative Procurement Reroofing.

[01:10:30] Legislation originally reported to the Committee on General Laws and then subsequently by the Committee on Appropriations. Deleted from Fairfax. Deleted through it. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 326 creates an exception, allowing certain re-roofing and roofing maintenance projects to be obtained through cooperative procurement contracts when the work does not involve structural modifications.

[01:10:49] This legislation will clarify that routine roofing maintenance and repairs should not be treated the same as major construction projects for the purposes of procurement. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Next up in the block is Senate Bill 391, which leads to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia and repeal several others, all related to the Commission on the Virginia Alcohol Safety Action Program, or VSAP.

[01:11:10] Legislation report to the Committee of the Courts of Justice. Doug from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. I'm sorry, and it was reported. Thank you. I apologize. And it was reported from Committee on Appropriation with the Amendment substitute, which was just moved. I apologize. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[01:11:26] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to delegate from Richmond City. Delegate Coutts. With the substitute, SB 391 is identical to my HB 862, which is a recommendation of the VASAP Commission. The bill consolidates the commission's statutory authority

into a single code section, codifies existing regulations, and creates a stakeholder work group to review the sustainability of the structure and funding model for VASAP.

[01:11:50] I move that the bill passes. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 459, which is legislated and seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Consumer Protection Act, liquefied petroleum gas filters, service disconnection requirements, civil penalties, legislation reporting Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment and then subsequent report by the Committee on Appropriation.

[01:12:08] Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to the Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill requires a liquefied petroleum gas filter within 14 days after receiving a customer's request to discontinue delivery service to offer in writing to remove any remaining gas from such customer's storage tank and reimburse the customer for the cost of the gas at the prevailing weight within 30 days.

[01:12:31] I move we pass the bill. Turning to page 8, Senate Bill 568 is by for the day, so therefore out of the block. Continuing with the block, we come next to Senate Bill 673, legislation to amend the Code of Virginia related to cyber-stalking penalty.

[01:12:48] Legislation report bidding for courts of justice with amendment-nate substitutes. That's reported by Coonan on Appropriations. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye? All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to the delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed.

[01:13:03] Yes, Mr. Speaker, the substitute clarifies that stalking conducted through electronically transmitted communications or cyber stalking is prohibited under Virginia law and expands the statute to include stalking of an intimate partner. I move passage of the bill. Over on page 9, we come to Senate Bill 778.

[01:13:19] Legislation seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia related display of obscene material to a minor unlawful penalty legislation by the Court of Justice and then also by the Committee on Appropriations. Devin Long County, Delegate Reed. Yes. Mr. Speaker, the bill expands the Virginia law, making it a class-six felony for an adult to display obscene items, child pornography, or grooming materials to a child under 13 with the intent to entice sexual activity.

[01:13:45] I move the passage of the legislation. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 815, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact sexual code of Virginia relating to school boards. Opening of the school year, certain alternative schedules, and schedule flexibility permitted. Legislation reporting committee on education.

[01:14:01] Delegate from Roanoke County, Delegate McNamara. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 815 is the cognate of my 1455, which passed this House 97 to 0. It adjusts the school opening commencement date for certain school divisions to 14 days before September 1st.

[01:14:18] I ask the body to pass the bill. And last in the Senate Bill's third reading or final passage on contested calendar block is Senate Bill 817, legislation amend the Code of Virginia relating to school

boards, classes, public, middle, and high schools, parental notification of course registration deadlines, and processes required.

[01:14:36] Legislation for Committee on Education. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 817 requires each school board to send a parental notification on the class schedule for each student. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bills pass?

[01:14:57] Close the roll. Ayes, 96, no, 0. Ayes, 96, no, 0. The bill's passed. Continuing with today's calendar, new category, Senate Bill's on third reading, regular calendar, page 10 of the printed version, if you're following along that way.

[01:15:17] We come first to Senate Bill 602, legislation to amend and reenact, Section Code of Virginia relating to Marcus Alert System, External Database Information Removal, Legislative Board of Committee on Public Safety. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 602 go by for the day.

[01:15:33] Without objection, Senate Bill 602 is by for the day. Over on page 11, we come next to Senate Bill 764. Legislation amended and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to deferred disposition in a criminal case, license, suspension, driving while under the influence.

[01:15:54] Legislative Report Committee for Courts of Justice with an amendment, and Delegate Kilgore has a floor amendment to that bill as well. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts.

[01:16:10] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 764 extends the deferred disposition docket to driving while under the influence, and it also amends the requirement that this have the approval of the Commonwealth Attorney.

[01:16:37] I move the passage of Senate Bill 764. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgill. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. What my amendment does, and I will ask folks to agree, is it taking... Delegate for Fairfax, Delegate Simon.

[01:16:54] Is that a move to pass by the floor amendment from Delegate Kilgore? Delegate for Fairfax, move that we pass by the floor amendment to Delegate Kilgore. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Can I speak? The eyes and nays have been called for.

[01:17:10] I think you're two minutes each, so we're going to start with your two minutes. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. What my amendment would do in subsection A would reinsert the language that was taken out where the Commonwealth attorney would have to agree in any cases, all the felony cases and things of that nature, and put this bill back to its original form where it would only apply to DUIs and things of that nature.

[01:17:39] I think the Commonwealth Attorney should be involved, the Commonwealth Attorney's Office should be involved if they are making sure that a deferred disposition would occur on a case. And that's why I had my floor amendment, Mr. Speaker. Thank you.

[01:17:56] Doug from Fairfax, Doug Simon. Mr. Speaker, speaking of the motion, so we just spent four hours, I think four and a half hours on Friday, interviewing judges and vetting them, talking to them about their attitude about things and trying to get a sense of who they were. And countless hours prior to that

spent with delegations, meeting with candidates for the judiciary, talking to them, making sure they get folks that reflect the values and politics, frankly, in some cases, and the public safety needs of their communities.

[01:18:25] I think we can trust those judges to make these decisions. I don't think we need to give one side a veto over these deferred disposition cases in pursuit of justice. I hope that we can all vote yes on the motion to pass by. A motion that says we trust our judges to make these decisions and we want them to help pursue justice.

[01:18:41] So again, I hope that members will vote yes on the motion to pass by. Shall the motion to pass by be agreed to? Madam Clerk? Clerk, we'll close the roll.

[01:18:58] Ayes, 62, noes, 35. Ayes, 62, noes, 35. The motion to pass by is agreed to. Continuing with third reading regular... Shall the bill... I'm sorry, that's me. Sorry. Shall the bill pass? Right? That's okay.

[01:19:15] Clerk, we'll close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes.

[01:19:32] Now we come to Senate Bill 221, Legislation Amendment re-enacced to go to Virginia relating to school bus, school crossing zones, excuse me, relating to school crossing zones, active times, legislation required on transportation. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:19:47] Senate Bill 221 allows localities to increase from 30 minutes up to 60 minutes, the period of time before and after regular school hours during which school crossing zones are active. If children are commuting to and from home, the bill passed unanimously out of the Transportation Committee, and I hope it is the will of the body to pass the legislation.

[01:20:07] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 80, noes 15.

[01:20:23] Ayes 80, noes 15. The bill passes. Over on page 12, we come to Senate Bill 20 and Senate Bill 108, both of which are by for the day. Therefore, on page 13, next bill before you is Senate Bill 115, which seeks to amend and reenact Section Code of Virginia related to concealed handgun permits, reciprocity with other states.

[01:20:42] The legislation was reported by the committee on public safety with the substitute, and then subsequently reported by the committee on appropriations with a differing amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I'm going to move the substitute from public safety and ask that the members vote no. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:21:02] Public safety committee substitute is rejected. The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Mr. Speaker, I'm now going to move the Appropriations Committee substitute and ask the members to vote yes. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed.

[01:21:18] Yes, Mr. Speaker, as the bill is now before us, it requires Virginia to recognize out-of-state concealed handgun permits only from states with similar eligibility requirements and a 24-7 permit verification with Virginia State Police. I move passage of the legislation. Delegate from Campbell County, Delegate is there.

[01:21:34] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, Virginia's long had bipartisan reciprocity agreements with other states. If we go tearing those apart, Congress may decide

to solve the problem for us. They've taken notice and legislation has been introduced. When Congress solves a problem like this, states often lose flexibility.

[01:21:54] Be careful what you wish for. You might get national reciprocity, whether you want it or not. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:22:16] Excuse me. Ayes 61, nos 34. Ayes 61, nos 34. The bill passes. House, excuse me, Senate Bill 122, SB 122, now before you seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia relating to school boards, student diabetes care, and management in schools, division-wide plan required.

[01:22:35] Legislative reporting on education with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Rasul, I mean, Delegate from Roark, no, Delegate Rasul. Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor? Say aye. All those opposed, no, the committee substitute is agreed to.

[01:22:50] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Roark, no, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Rasul means messenger, so I'm bringing a message today. This is the diabetes bill that we will never get rid of here, but what we've done by agreeing to conform, we've conformed it to House Bill 1301.

[01:23:11] What this does is represents really peace in the valley between a variety of stakeholders. We're hoping that it will stick that way, but Mr. Speaker, move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Kirk will close the roll.

[01:23:35] Ayes 96, noes 0. Ayes 96, noes 0. The bill passes. Over on page 14, we come to Senate Bill 190, which would direct the Department of Education to assess the impact of developing a program to provide student support programs to students enrolled in a public elementary or secondary school through certified student support agencies.

[01:24:01] Legislation Report Committee on Education with the amendment of the nature of substitute. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that this bill be passed by temporarily. SB 199 with all objections passed by temporarily.

[01:24:17] Therefore, next up, bottom of page 14 of the printed calendar, we come to Senate Bill 200. Senate Bill 200 seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia related to the Board of Education, Standards of Learning, Assessments, and Related Assessment Methods, Development, Administration, Scoring, and Release.

[01:24:36] Station Report Committee on Education with an amendment. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 200 is the cognate of my House Bill 299, which passed the House on February 17th on a vote of 86 to 11.

[01:24:56] It continues to reform and update the SOL process. I hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:25:18] Clerk will close the vote. Ayes. Eighty-two, no's 15. Ayes, 82, no's 15. The bill passes. Senate Bill 220 is by for the day. Therefore, the next bill, third reading regular category before you is Senate Bill 225. This is legislation that seeks to amend the code of Virginia related to Virginia Clean Energy Innovation Bank.

[01:25:37] Established. Report. Legislation report to the Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment of nature substitute and substitute report by the Committee on Appropriations. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the committee substitute and ask the body to reject the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[01:25:54] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. No. Committee substitute is rejected. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill creates the Virginia Clean Energy Innovation Bank to finance clean energy projects, greenhouse gas emission reduction projects, and other qualified projects through the strategic deployment of public funds.

[01:26:12] It's the cognate of my bill, and we're still just working out the final bits. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:26:32] Ayes 61, nos 34. Ayes 61, nos 34. The bill passes. Over on page 16, Senate Bill 261 has been referred to as probes. Therefore, bottom of page 16, we come to Senate Bill 271.

[01:26:49] 271 seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia related to the prescription drug affordability board established. Drug cost affordability review. Legislation reporting committee on appropriations. However, Delegate Delaney has a floor substitute, and then she also has floor amendments drawn to that substitute.

[01:27:09] Delegate Delaney. And thank you, Mr. Speaker. We've become aware of perhaps one more amendment that I would like to try to get in before the end of the day, so I'm going to move that we take this by temporarily and hopefully have everything to the clerk by the end of the calendar sb 271 is by temporarily without objection all right continuing over on page 17 we come to sb 299 legislation that seeks to amend and reenact portions of the code of virginia related institutions of higher education educational authorities uh centers committee funds institutes and partnerships new college institute

[01:27:49] board of directors membership and composition legislation reporting on education uh with an amendment nature of substitute. Delegate from Henrico, Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to a delegate from Henrico, Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 299, which is now a cognate to my HB 430, is a governance bill that updates the composition of the board of directors for New College Institute. The bill simply clarifies membership on the board by adjusting the number and types of members, and more importantly, the legislation is preserving existing appointments while ensuring that any future appointments reflect this updated structure.

[01:28:29] With that, Mr. Speaker, I'd like to move past the bill. Shall the bill pass? Shall the bill pass? First, we'll close the row.

[01:28:46] Ayes, 92, noes, 5. Ayes, 92, noes, 5. The bill passes. Senate Bill 341 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to private elementary and secondary schools, student codes of conduct, policies related to bullying and cyberbullying prevention and parental notification requirements.

[01:29:04] The Legislation Board Committee on Education with an amendment, nature of substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee

substitute is agreed to. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 341 ensures our private schools have policies in place to deal with incidents of bullying or cyberbullying.

[01:29:25] It's similar to my HB 894, which passed the House 73 to 24. The substitute improves the bill with language ensuring that the bullying is confirmed. I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:29:50] Ayes 66, nos 30. Ayes 66, nos 30. The bill passes. Over on page 8. Speaker, I rise for motion. Delegate from Honest and Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that we reconsider the vote by which we passed SB 225, I believe on page 15.

[01:30:10] I move that we reconsider the vote by which we passed or failed to adopt the committee. Did you vote on the prevailing side? I did. Marcus, Delegate Simon. fix it. Delegate Simon, Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I vote on the prevailing side by which we passed Senate Bill 225 on page 15 of the calendar. I move that we reconsider that vote. For what purpose? So that we can all correct our vote. We need to get the, Mr. Speaker, speaking of the motion, we need to get the amendment, the committee substitute back on the bill. And so we need to first reconsider the vote by which we passed it. Then we'll reconsider the vote by which we failed to adopt the substitute. Then we'll move to adopt the substitute again,

[01:30:49] and then we'll pass the bill again. So it'll be a different form than the Senate version. So we get the conference which is what the delegate from arlington wants initially thank you so the first motion mr speaker is that we reconsider the vote by which we adopted a passed senate bill 225 delegate from fairfax delegate simon moves both who've been here both he and lopez who've been here since jesus was a baby acts that we reconsider these votes so that they may fix their bills uh all those in favor say aye all those opposed no senate bill 225 is back before us madam now what

[01:31:25] Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to adopt the committee substitute, I move that we reconsider that motion. I have a vote on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass the committee substitute, although it acts that we reconsider the vote. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Now the committee substitute is back before us again for reconsideration.

[01:31:45] Now what would you like to do with your bill? Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute, and we isolate the vote yes, and then I'd like to move the bill. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee's substitute is agreed to. Shall the bill pass? Laurel and Hardy.

[01:32:11] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 63, no's 34. Ayes, 63, no's 34. The bill passes. Going back to page 18, or forward to page 18, continuing Senate Bill's third reading, regular, we come to Senate Bill 378, which seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia, repeal several others, all related to collective bargaining by public employees.

[01:32:38] Public Employee Relations Board established. Exclusive bargaining representatives report. Legislation report committee on labor and commerce. Amendment substitute. Substitute reported by the committee on appropriations. The delegate for Fairfax. Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[01:32:54] All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, with the substitute, this bill is now the cognate of my House Bill 1263, establishing

collective bargaining rights for public sector employees. I move passage of the bill. The delegate from Henry County, Delegate Phillips.

[01:33:12] Yeah, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. SB 378, collective bargaining for public employees, has real cost, and those costs will land on homeowners, they'll land on taxpayers. There are estimates all over the place showing policies like this could add up to roughly $900 a year on a mortgage, $300,000 home, and higher taxes and property taxes.

[01:33:33] And this is not an attack on our public employees. Our teachers, police, officers, firefighters, public servants work hard, and they deserve fair pay. The question is whether or not, and it's not a question of whether they should be compensated well, the question is ultimately who controls the budget and how much flexibility do local leaders retain?

[01:33:51] And the bigger question is who pays to make up the difference when the budget falls short? Mr. Speaker, my fear is they look like everyday hard-working Virginians. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass?

[01:34:17] Turk will close the roll. I-62, Nose 35. I-62, Nose 35. Bill passes.

[01:34:33] Senate Bill 394 is legislation that seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to the Board of Education, Artificial Intelligence, Use in Instructional Settings, Development of AI Safety Guidance Required, AI Innovation and Education Pilot Program Established Report, Legislation Report Committee on Education with Amendment Nature Substitute.

[01:34:51] The Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, now Senate Bill 394 is conformed to my House Bill 1186, which gathers some data on the use of artificial intelligence by school divisions, as many of us are concerned about the growing impact.

[01:35:17] This is the first time in history, in recorded history, where the generation of today has seen a cognitive decline compared to the previous generation. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. shall the bill pass? Kirk will close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 1. Ayes 96, noes 1, the bill passes.

[01:35:50] Over on page 19, we come to Senate Bill 427. This is legislation amended and reenacted a section of the code of Virginia related to high school graduation requirements, history and social study credits, certain substitutions permitted. Legislation report committee on education with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to the death of Long County Delegate Reed. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 427 now conforms to my House Bill 182 that allows African American history and AP African American studies to count

[01:36:24] as a verified history credit for graduation. I move passage of the legislation. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, nos 35. Ayes 62, nos 35. The bill passes. Senate Bill 491 As legislator seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to public schools, right to free public elementary and secondary education, discrimination based on immigration status prohibited, requirements, civil cause of action.

[01:37:03] Legislative report committee on education with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:37:19] Ladies and gentlemen of the House, Senate Bill 491, now with a substitute, is identical to my House Bill 836, which ensures that, regardless of status, that our children feel safe in public schools. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:37:38] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, nos 34. Ayes 63, nos 34. The bill passes. Senate Bill 494 is legislation to amend and reenact the portion of the Code of Virginia related to public institutions of higher education.

[01:38:00] Governing boards, powers and duties related to legal counsel, membership, appointment, terms, and composition, duties related to shared governance, requirements, workgroup, legislation, report committee on education with amendment nature substitutes.

[01:38:11] The House of BEDs. Mr. Clerk.

[01:39:14] Senate Bill 494, the title has been read. It was reported committee on education, and they reported that with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed? To all those in favor, say aye.

[01:39:31] All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to the delegate from Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin. The bill now conforms SB 494 to my HB 1385, which passed this body by a vote of 62 to 35. This bill revises the membership and duties of the Board of Visitors at each public institution of higher education.

[01:39:49] I move to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:40:02] There you go. Need all the help I can get. Clerk, close the roll. Ayes. 61, no's 35. Ayes 61, no's 35. The bill passes.

[01:40:17] Over on page 20, Senate Bills 518 and 536 are both by for the day. Therefore, page 21, Senate Bill's third reading regular, we come to Senate Bill 731, which is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to private companies providing public transportation services.

[01:40:35] Employee protections report. Legislation report committee on county, city, towns with an amendment of nature substitute. Substitute report on appropriations. And Delegate Helmer has floor amendments, three floor amendments, drawn to the CC&T substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer.

[01:40:52] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to those floor amendments, and then I'll move them quickly. I'm going to get the committee substitute first. I'll move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this is the public transportation employees protection bill that passed the House on basically a party line vote, House Bill 547.

[01:41:15] The floor amendments simply put the bill in line with the Senate bill in line with the House bill that's already en route to the governor. I hope we will pass the amendments. We'll adopt the amendments. Shall the floor amendments be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor amendments will agree to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer.

[01:41:32] Mr. Speaker, I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. I think that's the wrong one. Ayes 62, nos 35.

[01:41:50] Ayes 62, nos 35. The bill passes. Over on page 22, we come to Senate Bill 794, which seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia related to the Virginia Health Care Protection Act established, prohibition on extradition for certain crimes, penalties, legislation reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice.

[01:42:10] Delegate from Long County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 794 is the Virginia Health Care Protection Act. It bars Virginia law enforcement from assisting out-of-state investigations, arrests, or warrants concerning health care activity legal within the Commonwealth. I move passage of the legislation.

[01:42:26] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 60, noes 35.

[01:42:45] Ayes 60, noes 35. The bill passes. And, Ms. Speaker, members of the House, returning to page 14, we took by temporarily two bills. Over on page 14, we come to Senate Bill 190, which would direct a Department of Education to assess the impact of developing a program to provide student support programs to students enrolled in a public elementary or secondary school through certified student support agencies.

[01:43:12] Legislation was reported from the Committee on Education with an amendment age substitute. From Norfolk, Delegate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that this bill be passed by for the day. Without objection, SB 190 is by for the day. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney.

[01:43:41] So now, Ms. Speaker, members of the House, return on page 16. We return to Senate Bill 271, which went by temporarily. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move this bill go by for the day. Without objection, the bill is by for the day.

[01:44:02] So with those two... House will be at ease.

[01:44:30] That's right. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we have completed Senate bills on third reading regular. Therefore, we come to a new category, House bills with Senate amendments, half a dozen or so bills there. First up is bottom of page 22, House Bill 242, which is legislation that relates to public utilities, multiple budget plan payment increases within 12 months prohibited notice required.

[01:44:57] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with an amendment, Senate amendments before you. Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate amendments to this bill, as a reminder, this is a bill that protects people on budget plans for public utilities. Having conversations with the stakeholders and a few of the senators, we removed water utility companies from the bill.

[01:45:18] After having discussion, water utilities are typically handled by localities, and there's a handful of companies that are doing this. So I move that we accept the Senate amendments. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[01:45:39] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 4. Ayes 93, noes 4. The Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 358, now before you, would amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia related to Medicare Supplement Policies, Regulations Establishing Minimum Standards, Workgroup Report.

[01:45:58] Legislation originally passed the House. House passed that with an amendment. The Senate amendment to HB 358 is before you. Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'm going to move the Senate amendments and ask that the body vote aye. Speaking briefly to that motion. Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate simply removed the term risk adjustment mechanisms from the initial portion of this bill which allows for Medigap study.

[01:46:20] One of the elements of that study in the task force is the risk adjustment mechanism, so they didn't want to change what the commission's authority was. I hope we will adopt the amendment. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[01:46:43] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 395 is legislation relating to electric utilities, small portable solar generation devices, residential landlord and tenant act.

[01:46:59] Legislation originally passed the House, let's pass that with the substitute, which is now before you. That is from Fairfax. Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As a reminder, this bill makes clean energy more affordable, more accessible, and more practical for everyday Virginians by removing the red tape for plug-in, otherwise known as BAPMoney Solar.

[01:47:14] What the substitute will do is it adds a lot of technical stuff, but it convenes a work group to evaluate safety standards and delays the bill's effective date to January 1, 2027. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:47:41] Ayes, 93, no's 4. Ayes, 93, no's 4. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 481 at the bottom of page 23 is by for the day, over on page 24. Therefore, we come to a delegate of all Donato's House Bill 636, which relates to prohibiting employer seeking wage or salary history of prospective employees, wage or salary range transparency, cause of action. Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with an amendment, and that's Senate's amendments before you.

[01:48:11] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that we adopt the Senate amendment. Speaking to that amendment. This bill, this movement makes it identical to the Senate bill that already came and passed floor. It simply adds a notice of cure provision related to the wage range posting requirements in the bill.

[01:48:31] We're very happy to work with our business community in the Virginia Chamber of Commerce so that we have a 15-business-day right to cure. Mr. Speaker, I move that we adopt the Senate Amendment. Shall the Senate Amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:48:54] Ayes, 63, noes, 34. Ayes, 63, noes, 34. The Senate Amendment is adopted. House Bill 1022 is legislation relating to consumer protection. automatic renewal or continuous service offers, disclosure, and cancellation.

[01:49:13] Legislation originally passed the House, has passed the Senate with a substitute, and that Senate substitute is before you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill strengthens consumer protections by making it easier to cancel a subscription. The Senate substitute has some in-person

language requirements that are overly cumbersome, so I move the substitute and ask the members to reject the motion.

[01:49:37] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the row. Ayes. Ayes, 1. Noes, 96.

[01:49:52] Ayes, 1. Noes, 96. The Senate substitute is rejected. And last bill in this category is House Bill 1173, which relates to the Virginia Human Rights Act, reasonable accommodation for no limitations related to menopause.

[01:50:09] Report. Legislation originally passed the House. Senate with substitute. Senate substitutes before you. Deb from Fairfax. Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. The Senate Substitute makes House Bill 1173 a cognate of Senate Bill 258, which we voted on last week. This bill adds menopause and perimenopause to existing protections under the Virginia Human Rights Act.

[01:50:28] I move the House to agree to the Senate Substitute. Shall the Senate Substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:50:44] Ayes 62, Noes 34, Abstentions 1. Ayes 62, Noes 34, Abstentions 1. The Senate Substitute is adopted. Continuing with today's calendar, we come to a new category. On this Monday, Memorial Resolutions laid on the Speaker's table.

[01:51:03] Memorial Resolutions be adopted in block are listed on pages 25 through 32, with the exception of House Joint Resolution 170, Senate Joint Resolution 149, House Joint Resolution 231, House Resolution 224 is out of the block, and I think earlier I misspoke earlier.

[01:51:31] So House Resolution 231 is in the block. House Resolution 224 is out of the block. It's by until the 11th. And then the final bill out of the block is House Resolution 273. All the other bills listed on pages 25 through 32, except those that I just mentioned, are now before you as a block.

[01:51:49] All those in favor of adopting the memorial resolutions laid on the speaker's table are listed on pages 25 through 32, with the exception of those that were removed from the block. As announced by the clerk, pages 25 through 32 of the calendar will rise. The resolution is agreed to.

[01:52:12] New category, commending resolutions laid on the speaker's table. The commending resolutions to be adopted in block are listed on pages 33 through 49 with the exception of House Joint Resolution 196, HJR 197, and 198.

[01:52:28] Those three are out of the block. House Joint Resolution 210 is out of the block. House Resolution 195 is out of the block. House Resolution 206 and 210, those are out of the block.

[01:52:47] resolution 235 is out of the block and all the other bills listed on pages um 33 through 49 are uh in the block that's now before you all those in favor but the delegate from henrico delegate mcquinn thank you mr speaker mr speaker i moved it h um r194 uh go by for the day thank you without objection house resolution 194 go by for the day so i guess it's out of the block all those in favor of adopting the commending resolutions laid on the speaker's table found on pages 33 through 49 with with the exception of those announced by the clerk of the printed calendar, will say aye.

[01:53:26] Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. And, Ms. Speaker, new category, Senate bills with recommendations by the governor. So we did two of these last week. I think these are two more that might be related. Page 49, we come first to Senate Bill 51, which is an act relating to election of certain governing bodies, conversion to single-member districts.

[01:53:51] Legislation originally passed the House, obviously passed the Senate, went to the governor, who has returned recommendations. And those recommendations by the governor are available to the members online and to the public as well online, and they are now before you. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate, ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:54:06] Mr. Speaker, speaking to the governor's recommendations. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this Senate Bill 51 is the Senate cognate to my HB 168, and it adds the emergency clause, as we did last week, as the clerk said. I hope it's still with the body to pass the governor's recommendations. Shall the bill be amended and, of course, with the recommendations of the governor?

[01:54:32] Close the roll. Excuse me. Ayes 67, nos 29. Ayes 67, nos 29. The governor's recommendation agreed to. And lastly, in this category, we come to Senate Bill 681, which is an act relating to city council voting districts.

[01:54:53] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate, went to the governor, who has offered recommendations, which are now before you. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Commerce Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the recommendation. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 681 is a cognate to my House Bill 187 that we passed last week, the recommendation we passed last week on a vote of 66 to 29.

[01:55:17] The governor has simply added an emergency clause to this bill to amend the charter of the city of Virginia Beach. So, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the governor's recommendation, and I ask that we vote yes. Shall the bill be amended in the course with the recommendation of the governor? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:55:41] Ayes. 67, noes. 27, abstentions. 1. Ayes. 67, noes. 27, abstentions. 1. The bill, the governor's recommendation is agreed to. And, Mr. Speaker, having received no further conference reports, there's no further business before us. So, at the House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour.

[01:55:58] Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communications, just the announcements for the, oh, I'm sorry, I do have an extra one announcement before that. Speaker points several more conferees. For House Bill 110, the Speaker points Delegates Lauffer, Clark, and Moorfield.

[01:56:17] For House Bill 110, Delegates Lauffer, Clark, and Moorfield will be the conferees on behalf of the House. For House Bill 505, the Speaker points Delegates McAuliffe, Reed, and Cherry. HB 505, Delegates McAuliffe, Reed, and Cherry.

[01:56:34] And for House Bill 1487, the Speaker appoints Delegates Singh, Sullivan, and O'Quinn. HB 1487, Delegates Singh, Sullivan, and O'Quinn, and that is companion legislation to SB 827. That will be updated on your member pages momentarily.

[01:56:54] Looking ahead to just the meeting schedule today is the last day for committees to meet, as we mentioned before. The Committee on Appropriations is 15 minutes. So Committee on Appropriations will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment at the House a little bit after 2 o'clock up on the House Appropriations Committee room on the 12th floor of the GAB.

[01:57:14] And Delegate Watts said, I believe, or something communicated that the Northern Virginia Delegation Caucus is meeting today at 5 o'clock. They'll be on the 10th floor subcommittee room. So those

are the only two legislative activities for it this afternoon.

[01:57:31] And then looking ahead to tomorrow, the conservative caucus is meeting at 7.30 in this 8, 8.30. Okay, the conservative caucus will be meeting at 8.30. We'll update that. They'll be in the House subcommittee room 8 over in the General Assembly building on the 8th floor, of course.

[01:57:53] And then prior to going in at noon, the two caucuses will meet beforehand. The Democratic caucus is meeting at 11.15 tomorrow. And then the Republican caucus, 11.15. So both caucuses will be meeting 11-15, Democrats in House Room 1, Republicans in House Room 2.

[01:58:09] Mr. Speaker, that's all the announcements I have. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. The Northern Virginia caucus will meet at 5 o'clock today. You're coming in early.

[01:58:33] Yep, that's me. Okay, 10-15. That's on me. I don't understand. What are those Mondays? So I apologize. So the House is going in at 11 tomorrow, and I think the tentative schedule is at 11 for the rest of the week. unless that has changed, but since we're going in at 11 tomorrow, then the two caucuses would be meeting not at 11.15. They'll be meeting at 10.15. So Democrats in House Room 1, Republicans at 10.15 in House Room 2, and I apologize.

[01:59:02] Delicate from Alexander. Delicate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourned today, adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 11 a.m. Delicate from Alexander. Delicate Herring moves that when the House adjourns today, adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 11 a.m. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring.

[01:59:18] Mr. Speaker, move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that the House do now adjourn. As many in favor, the motion would say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 11. 11 a.m., Mr. Clerk, 11 a.m.

